

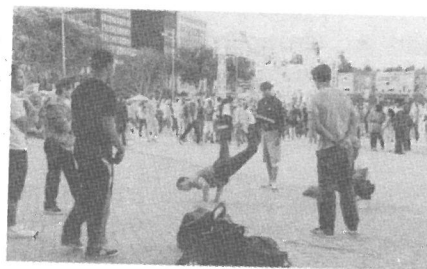
ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an article about street culture in Hong Kong:

“We’re no trouble at all”

Street culture – seen in the likes of street art, dance, graffiti and skateboarding – is becoming far more accepted than it used to be in Hong Kong. And yet youngsters who enjoy dancing in the street or doing tricks with their skateboards at night are sometimes still dismissed as “troublemakers” and “youths at risk”. Yeung Kin-tong, a social worker at the Chai Wan Centre of the Chinese YMCA of Hong Kong, is familiar with such negative labels.



“People see kids hanging out at night and think they are troublemakers. But the truth is they can only enjoy their hobby at night, when there are fewer people around,” Yeung says. “They are not making trouble; they are trying to avoid it.” Yeung started interacting with youths who began dancing and skateboarding on the street a decade ago. She adds that Hongkongers have come a long way in recognising the value of street culture.

“People used to frown upon teens on skateboards. They did not respect it as a sport. Same with street dancing or graffiti. People did not consider them as art. But that was in the past; now people understand more about street culture,” she says. Yeung cites the Hong Kong International Street Jam Festival held on April 19 at Victoria Park, which was the first government-sponsored street culture event. “Street culture is gaining recognition,” she says.

Your group wants to give a presentation about street culture in Hong Kong. Discuss with your group what to include in your presentation. You may want to talk about:

- why some people think street culture is negative
- reasons why street culture is becoming more popular
- how to change people’s attitudes towards street culture
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you have friends who like street dancing?
2. Do your parents allow you to go out with your friends at night?
3. What do you think of people who skateboard in the street?
4. Should schools promote street culture?
5. Should teenagers be encouraged to take part in street culture?
6. What difficulties may street performers encounter?
7. What do you think of people who write graffiti?
8. Do you think street culture promotes creativity?